
NOTE

On Windows, you can run the `python` and `pip` commands. But on macOS and Linux, these command names are for Python version 2 only, so instead you'll need to run `python3` and `pip3`. Keep this in mind whenever you see `python` or `pip` in this book.

IDLE, the IDE that comes with Python, doesn't have a linter or the capability of having one installed.

How to Ask for Programming Help

When internet searches and linters fail to solve your problem, you can ask for programming help on the internet. But there is an etiquette to efficiently asking for advice. If experienced software developers are willing to answer your questions at no charge, it's best to make efficient use of their time.

Asking strangers for programming help should always be a last resort. Hours or days could pass before someone replies to your posted question, if you get a reply at all. It's much faster to search the web for other people who have already asked your question and read their answers. Online documentation and search engines were made to relieve the question-answering work that would otherwise have to be done by humans.

But when you've exhausted your options and must ask a human audience your programming question, avoid the following common mistakes:

- Asking if it's okay to ask a question instead of just asking it
- Implying your question instead of asking it directly
- Asking your question on the wrong forum or website
- Writing an unspecific post headline or email subject, such as "I have a problem" or "Please help"
- Saying "my program doesn't work" but not explaining how you want it to work
- Not including the full error message
- Not sharing your code